



Pro Hackathon 2026 Tracks & Handbook

Dates: September 19–20, 2026

Venue: Grand Pera, Beyoğlu, Istanbul

Organized by: Rise In x Stellar

Overview

The Pro Hackathon runs two parallel tracks, open to different builder profiles and judged against different bars.

	Genesis Track	Scale Track
Who it's for	Open applicants, experienced developers chasing a new features	Residency graduates + invited teams with proven Stellar experience + InstAward/SCF grantee
What they build	A net-new product, built from scratch and shipped with a real Stellar integration (core feature or anchor)	An integration or composition on top of existing Stellar ecosystem protocols (core feature or anchor). Last day is the Lounge Day for Scale Track participants. They will present the products in front of SDF team, invited investor/VCs/founders.
Entry	Open application	Invite-only
Bar	A working prototype: meets the Genesis and Scale Track Requirements, deployed on testnet.	Same technical bar as Genesis. The difference is eligibility-plus two extra deliverables: an architecture diagram and a post-hackathon roadmap toward SCF/InstAward.



Agenda

Day 1

09.00-10.00	Registration to the Pro Hackathon
10.00-10.15	Welcoming speech by the Stellar team and official kick-off of the hackathon
10.15-10.30	Hackathon briefing & judging overview
10.30-11.30	Workshop #1: Agentic payments & AI agents on Stellar
11.40-12.30	Workshop#2: SCF Overview
12.40-13.30	Workshop #3: Anchor Integration
13.30-15.00	Lunch
13.00-16.00	a. Idea validation with the mentors + office hours b. Team formation mixer c. Hacking time
16.40-18.30	Hacking time & Mentor Office Hours
18.30-19.30	Dinner
19.30→ Overnight	Open hacking session

Day 2

10.00-12.00	Hacking time + office hours
12.00-13.00	Mentoring - Feedback on the projects + office hours Project Submission Deadline → 12.00
12.00-13.00	Lunch



13.00-14.30	Demo Day (Genesis Track) - Genesis jury only
14.30-15.00	Genesis Track Winners Decision
13.00-16.00	Lounge Day (Residency + Scale Track) - including Scale Track jury, decision, investor/VC audience invited network session
16.00-16.30	Closing Ceremony + Awards

Genesis and Scale Track Requirements

Both tracks are judged against the same three requirements.

1. **Integration:** build on an existing Stellar protocol from the [Eligible Integration Partners](#) list below.
2. **Anchor / Local Payments:** give the product a real fiat rail using an anchor or another anchor from the list. Concretely: a user should be able to put real Turkish lira in and get a usable balance out, or the reverse.
3. **Core Feature:** the integration is load-bearing, part of what the product does.

At the end of the event, the metrics tracked are: **how many teams shipped a core feature integration, how many shipped an anchor integration, how many captured real traction, and how many onboarded real users.**

Eligible Integration Partners

Curated from the official [SCF Integration List](#), filtered for integrations realistically doable in a 2-day hackathon window. Teams are not limited to this list; any protocol from the full SCF Integration List qualifies.

Category	Protocol	What it does	Resources
DeFi - Yield	DeFindex	Yield infrastructure / vault aggregator for wallets & apps	Docs · Quickstart · API Reference · Discord
DeFi - Lending	Blend v2	Lending pool protocol	Docs · Discord



DeFi - DEX/Swap	Aquarius	Liquidity & swap routing across Stellar DEX markets	Docs · Discord
DeFi - DEX/Swap	Soroswap	Routing API aggregating Soroban + classic liquidity	Docs · API Reference · Discord
DeFi - DEX/Swap	Stellar Broker	Multi-source liquidity swap router	Docs
Cross-chain	Circle CCTP	Native 1:1 USDC transfer across chains	Docs · Sample app · Discord
Cross-chain	Near Intents	Multi-chain execution / intent routing	1Click API · Examples
Cross-chain	Allbridge	Native stablecoin bridging, EVM ↔ non-EVM	Docs · Discord
Wallets	Stellar Wallets Kit	Toolkit to connect Stellar-compatible wallets	Docs · Repo · Discord
Wallets	Privy	Embedded email/social-based wallet onboarding	Docs · Dev Slack
Wallets	DFNS	Wallets-as-a-Service (WaaS)	Docs · Help Center
On/Off-ramp	Bridge	Multi-currency payments/treasury settlement	Docs · Support
On/Off-ramp	BlindPay	Global payments, fiat + stablecoin	Docs · API Reference · Discord

Official Stellar Skills

These are official skill files from skills.stellar.org:



- [Anchors](#): how to integrate with or build a Stellar anchor: fiat on/off-ramps, deposits/withdrawals, KYC, core SEP flows (1/6/10/12/24/31/38). The direct technical reference for anyone doing the anchor integration.
- [Stellar Integration Finder](#): finds the right existing Stellar project to integrate with (wallet, oracle, anchor, DEX, indexer) and routes to the matching build skill. Useful for teams still deciding what to integrate.
- [SEPs, CAPs & Ecosystem](#): picks the right SEP or CAP for a given feature.
- [DeFindex SDK](#) and [Soroswap SDK](#): official integration skills for two of the protocols in the table above.
- [SCF Submission Radar](#) and [Stellar Scout](#): for teams planning to apply to SCF/InstAward post-event; positions an idea against prior submissions and drafts pitches.

Submission requirement: teams should cite which specific skill file(s) (by path, e.g. [skills/standards/SKILL.md](#)) they used during development.

Prize Distribution

Total prize pool: \$15,000

Each track will be evaluated independently based on its own criteria, project maturity, execution quality, and overall potential.

Track	Genesis Track	Scale Track
1st	\$3000	\$3,500
2nd	\$2000	\$2,500
3rd	\$1,500	\$1,500
4th	\$1000	-

Genesis Track

Track Detail



Genesis Track is open build: pick a problem, form or bring a team, and ship a working Stellar product from zero in two days. Every project still meets the Genesis and Scale Track Requirements above, including a real integration.

What actually separates Genesis from Scale is the motivation: Genesis teams are competing for the \$7,500 prize pool.

Eligibility

- Open to any team
- Teams may form on-site or arrive pre-formed
- Teams of up to 4 people

Scale Track

Track Detail

Scale Track is invite-only, for teams past the first-prototype stage. Teams compose on top of what the Stellar ecosystem already has: a lending protocol, a DEX, an oracle, a vault aggregator, or an anchor for real fiat rails and ship something that makes that infrastructure more useful.

Scale teams are competing for the \$7,500 prize pool and are building toward SCF and InstAward funding post-event.

The motivation is different: teams are building toward SCF and InstAward funding, Lounge Day with the SDF team members and the post-event application push exist to get strong teams into that pipeline.

Eligibility

- Stellar Residency graduates are automatically eligible
- External applicants: at least one team member must show proven smart contract / Soroban experience (GitHub history, prior project, hackathon track record)
- The team should briefly state which Stellar protocol they plan to integrate with and why it creates ecosystem value. Come up with a qualified idea.
- Team member number depends on the scope



Genesis & Scale Track Flow

Stage	What happens
Integration	Teams build the real integration with their chosen protocol and a real fiat rail via an anchor and add a core feature to the product.
Testing	Integration gets tested, edge cases and bugs get fixed, contract gets verified on testnet
User onboarding & marketing growth	Teams with a live product can onboard real users during this window. With an existing product, teams try to get new users onboarded during the hackathon itself.
Reviews	Submission, mentor feedback, and final jury review
Demo Day	Presenting to the Genesis Track jury
Lounge Day	Presenting to the Scale Track jury and invited investors/VCs

Judging & Submission Criteria

Will be announced soon...

Judging Process

Project Submission: All teams participating in both the Genesis and Scale Tracks are expected to submit their projects before the submission deadline in accordance with the hackathon requirements.

Finalist Selection: Once submissions are closed, all projects will be evaluated based on the official hackathon judging criteria. Finalist teams from each track will then be announced.



Final Jury Presentations: Only the finalist teams will present their projects live to the jury.

Judging Criteria

1. Meaningful Idea & Real-World Impact

Evaluate whether the project solves a meaningful problem with real adoption potential.

- Is the problem statement clear, specific, and well-defined?
- Does the project address a genuine real-world use case (payments, DeFi, RWAs, identity, agentic commerce, remittances, etc.)?
- If successful, who benefits from the solution and what is its potential impact?
- Is there evidence of market viability, including a clear target user or customer segment?

2. Technical Implementation

Assess the quality and completeness of the technical execution.

- Is the project deployed on Stellar Testnet with working functionality (not mocked or hardcoded)?
- Does the application work reliably from end to end?
- Are Soroban authentication and storage patterns used correctly (instance, persistent, temporary)?
- Is the system architecture appropriate for the problem and clearly documented?
- Scale Track only: Is a Mermaid architecture diagram included and does it accurately represent the system?
- Passkeys or smart wallets are considered a bonus, not a requirement.

3. Ecosystem Fit

Measure how deeply the project integrates with the Stellar ecosystem.

- Does the project integrate with an eligible Stellar protocol or ecosystem partner?
- Is the integration essential to the product rather than superficial?
- Does the project implement a real Anchor or local payments flow (e.g. TRY ↔ Stellar assets via SEP standards)?
- Does it make effective use of Stellar SDKs, CLI, and Skills resources?
- Are the relevant Stellar Skills references documented in the submission?

Note: Anchor and local payments integrations are weighted more heavily than the other Ecosystem Fit criteria for both tracks.

4. User Experience

Evaluate usability and product quality.

- Is the interface intuitive for first-time, non-crypto users?
- Are the implemented features clearly demonstrated within the UI?



- Is the overall product complete, polished, and easy to navigate?

5. Traction & Continuity

Consider the project's potential beyond the hackathon.

- Did the team validate the product with real users during the event?
- Is there a credible roadmap for post-hackathon development?
- Does the team clearly indicate whether they plan to pursue SCF, InstaAwards, or another continuation path?
- Is the team realistically capable of continuing development after the event?

6. Presentation & Documentation

Judge how effectively the project is communicated.

- Is the project clearly explained in the demo and README?
- Can judges easily understand the product, architecture, and user flow?
- Do the documentation and testing instructions make the project easy to evaluate?
- Is the submission mature and well-structured enough to be a strong candidate for a future Stellar Community Fund (SCF) or InstaAwards application?

How To Submit Your Project

Judging Portal

All teams must submit their project through the judging portal before the submission deadline. Incomplete or missing submissions will not be evaluated.

Submission Portal: TBD.

Your submission must include:

- Team name and all team members' full names and contact information
- All relevant project links (GitHub repository, live demo, deployment URL)
- Presentation/pitch deck link
- Selection of the hackathon track(s) you are applying to



Hackathon Test • ACTIVE May 26, 2026 — Sep 4, 2026		SUBMISSIONS 2 all active	ACTIVE COMPETITORS 2 all valid	AVG TOTAL SCORE 10.5 on 2 scored	DAYS REMAINING 100 until Sep 4, 2026
Team, name, or email...		All tracks		Up to date	
Project Presentation	Individual / Team	Team Members	Project Name	Total	MJ Mahmut J.
https://docs.google.com/...	Team	Muhammed Koc muhammed_koc@outlook.com +905535378774 Dila Yapici dila yapici@gmail.com +905543156666	Donation_Page	14	6 2ND
https://hckrnews.com/	Individual	Feyzanur Ates feyzanurates4@gmail.com +905066533794	stello_finance	7	7 1ST
Rows per page 20		1 - 2 of 2			

Important: You will only be evaluated for the tracks you select during submission. Projects will not be considered for tracks that were not chosen at the time of submission.

Workshop Details

Workshop#1 Agentic payments & AI agents on Stellar

This workshop covers both halves of its title: how AI agents pay for things on Stellar, and how AI coding tools help you build the agent.

We'll start with agentic payments: **x402** (pay-per-request HTTP APIs, zero-XLM clients via the OZ Channels facilitator) and **MPP** (Machine Payments Protocol) in both Charge mode (per-request, no facilitator dependency) and Session mode (a payment channel for high-frequency agent traffic one deposit, hundreds of off-chain-signed requests, one settlement).

You'll see a live x402-protected API get called by an agent client, and walk through when to reach for x402 vs. MPP Charge vs. MPP Session. Then we'll cover the AI-agent building side: integrating free AI models into tools like VS Code and Claude Code, setting up a working dev environment without paid APIs, and combining these into a practical automation workflow. We'll close with a walkthrough of *stellar-build*, an open-source project showing AI used directly inside a production-style codebase.

By the end, you'll be able to stand up a paid API a Stellar agent can call, and have your own AI-assisted dev environment ready for the rest of the hackathon.



<https://github.com/kaankacar/stellar-build>

Reference skill: [skills/agentic-payments/SKILL.md](#)

Workshop#2 SCF Overview

We'll walk through what SCF reviewers are actually evaluating when they read a submission. That distinction is everything. It's the difference between a project that gets funded and keeps growing, and one that gets a demo-day round of applause and quietly disappears.

Workshop#3 Scale: Anchor Integration

This workshop is about that edge: how anchor works as a TRY anchor, how the underlying SEP flows turn a blockchain balance into money someone can actually spend or receive in Turkey, and why "does this integrate with local rails" is quickly becoming the question that separates a crypto demo from a product people use.

What is Lounge Day?

Lounge Day is Scale Track only: the room the rest of the hackathon builds toward.

Scale track teams pitch to the SDF team, and invited investors, founders and VCs.

"Traction" here means what SCF, InstAward, and real investors mean by it: a working integration, a roadmap for what happens after the Pro Hackathon, and a founder who can explain the product and what's next.

What you walk out with:

- Direct facetime with the investors, founders and VCs in the room
- A warm path into SCF and InstAward: Rise In and the Stellar team support the Scale teams on their application/next steps
- A Rise In referral into their network, for projects that fit
- [Next step funding](#) beyond InstAward/SCF



Other Details

General Requirements

Project submissions must include the following:

The Narrative “Why”

- A brief explanation of what you are building, what it fixes, who it's helping, why it's important, and what your value proposition is.

Your MVP (Minimum Viable Product)

- This is the primary deliverable: your code. Provide a URL to your public GitHub repository with a well-defined README, your documented contracts, links to deployed artifacts, your front-end, and your working demo.
- Be sure to use the Soroban SDK and deploy your contracts to the Stellar testnet.

Technical Docs

- Technical design docs explaining how your project fits together, what the main components are, why you made various design decisions, what tradeoffs you made, and what challenges you overcame.

Presentation Template

We have prepared an official presentation template for all teams. **Please make a copy of the template and use it as the base for your pitch;** do not present directly from the shared template file.

You are welcome to add additional slides as needed, but the provided structure should serve as your foundation. Using the template ensures judges can follow a consistent format and helps you cover all the key points they will be looking for.

 [Presentation Template](#)

Hacker Resources

Resource Hub's

- **Stellar Ecosystem Resources:** <https://github.com/stellar/ecosystem-resources>



- **Stellar AI Skills:** <https://skills.stellar.org/>

Smart Wallets

- Demo chat application - built specifically to help inspire you for this hackathon. Available in [Svelte/Astro](#), [React](#), and [Vanilla](#) flavors.
- **Passkey-Kit:** <https://github.com/kalepail/smart-account-kit> - a TypeScript SDK for creating and managing Stellar smart wallets.
- Smart Wallet Docs: developers.stellar.org/docs/build/apps/smart-wallets - knowledgebase, examples, and resources for using passkeys for wallet authentication.
- **Smart Contract Authorization:** developers.stellar.org/docs/learn/encyclopedia/security/authorization - the contract authorization framework for Stellar smart contracts.

Smart Contract Development

- **Getting Started:** developers.stellar.org/docs/smart-contracts/getting-started/setup - the gateway to the Stellar smart contract developer experience.
- **Example Contracts:** developers.stellar.org/docs/build/smart-contracts/example-contracts - sample code for DeFi features like liquidity pools, token swaps, etc.

Dapp Development

- **Frontend Templates** - fork and hit the ground running.
[Scaffold Stellar Astro Template](#)
[SvelteKit with Passkey Kit Template](#)
- **Guestbook Tutorial:** developers.stellar.org/docs/build/apps/guestbook/overview - a dapp tutorial with passkey-powered smart wallets.
- **Build Applications Tutorials:** developers.stellar.org/docs/building-apps/overview - JavaScript implementations of common wallet functionality.
- **Stellar Design System:** design-system.stellar.org - components and styles for easier React development.

Explore the Network

- **Stellar Lab:** lab.stellar.org - interact with the network and query activity.
- **Stellar.Expert:** stellar.expert - block explorer for ledger entries, accounts, assets, analytics.

Connect to the Network

- **OpenZeppelin Relayer:** docs.openzeppelin.com/relayer
- **Stellar RPC:** developers.stellar.org/docs/data/apis/rpc - real-time access to Stellar network data.

Build on the Network



- **Developer Tools:** developers.stellar.org/docs/tools/developer-tools - organized list of available tools and services.
- **Get Testnet Funds**
<https://lab.stellar.org/account/fund?network=testnet&label=Testnet&horizonUrl=https://horizon-testnet.stellar.org&rpcUrl=https://soroban-testnet.stellar.org&passphrase=Test%20SDF%20Network%20-%20September%202015;>
- **SDK Library:** developers.stellar.org/docs/tools/sdks/library - Stellar SDKs in almost every language.
- **Stellar Ecosystem Resources:** github.com/stellar/ecosystem-resources - resources for in-person events and hackathons.
- **Frontend Bindings:**
developers.stellar.org/docs/build/smart-contracts/getting-started/hello-world-frontend - generate a typed NPM package for frontend integration.

Stablecoin Resources

- **Circle USDC and EURC Testnet Faucet:** faucet.circle.com - testnet tokens for two widely circulated stablecoins.
- **OpenZeppelin Open Source Relayer & Monitor Docs:**
docs.openzeppelin.com/open-source-tools
- **a16z - How Stablecoins Will Eat Payments:** a16zcrypto.com

Agentic Resources

- <https://developers.stellar.org/docs/build/agentic-payments>
- <https://developers.stellar.org/docs/build/agentic-payments/x402>
- <https://developers.stellar.org/docs/build/agentic-payments/x402/built-on-stellar>
- <https://developers.stellar.org/docs/build/agentic-payments/x402/quickstart-guide>

Privacy Resources

- <https://developers.stellar.org/docs/build/apps/privacy>
- <https://developers.stellar.org/docs/build/apps/zk>
- <https://github.com/kaankacar/Drand-Relay>
- <https://github.com/NethermindEth/stellar-private-payments>

Oracle

- <https://reflector.network/>
- <https://developers.stellar.org/docs/data/oracles>
- <https://noeracle.org/> - docs.noeracle.org

